



MUKESH AMBANI

"We are all Indians first. Mumbai, Chennai and Delhi belong to all Indians. That is the reality."

SAAMNA

"Marathi people have as much right over Mumbai as Mukesh Ambani has over the Reliance empire. Don't meddle in the issue of Marathi *manoos*."



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against south Indians in the 1960s. It is arguable whether the plank exists but even if it did, Uddhav and his cohorts lack the charisma and the political acumen of a Raj Thackeray to carry it off. Raj's men have been hitting out at soft targets like taxiwallahs and students from north India, but have been careful not to touch iconic personalities like Ambani or Tendulkar.

In desperation and in the name of the old tiger, Uddhav's men are running riot in the party's editorial mouthpiece *Saamna*, taking potshots at high-profile people to ensure space in national dailies and TV channels. Desperation has resulted in suicidal lunacy. Why else would a party target born-and-bred in Mumbai Marathi *manoos* Tendulkar? Not satisfied, the Sena attacked Ambani for something he said in faraway London.

What has made the battle more interesting is some of the high-profile names from Bollywood and business

coming out against petty politics. With the likes of Ambani and Tendulkar protesting against parochial mindsets, the choices aren't easy given that on the ground there isn't such a big issue. Says Atul Kulkarni, Marathi actor of *Rang De Basanti* fame, "Politicians are trying to foster a feeling of insecurity in the minds of Marathis so that they can gather support. We have to be more mature as citizens and voters to see that today it's Marathi versus non-Marathi, tomorrow it will be Muslim versus Hindu."

The party think tank—if there is one—is obviously cut off from GenNext. Aspiration is the calling card of this generation and with half of India under the age of 25, political parties are queueing up at colleges and universities to woo the next poll voter, not damn their icons. Uddhav and company have obviously not realised that the GenNext of 2010 is very different from the GenNext of the 1960s when Bal Thackeray started the party. This is best reflected in a chorus of demands from a cross section of the populace for the Government to act.

With Mumbai becoming a bone of contention, representatives from business and Bollywood say it's about time the Government decided on the fate of the city and its people.

Actor Manoj Bajpai says, "I am ready to leave the city and go back to my state, but for that the Government has to amend the Constitution. If that is not the case it

MOHAN BHAGWAT

"Mumbai is for all Indians... nobody can prevent Indians from moving to any part of the country in search of employment."

SAAMNA

"This city belongs to Maharashtra and Marathi *manoos*. If RSS wants to talk of protecting Hindi, they should do it in the south first."

UDDHAV HAS DRAGGED BAL THACKERAY OUT OF RETIREMENT TO RESCUE THE SHIV SENA

